Ctrl+Alt+Steal

Ctrl+Alt+Steal, presented by Neural Hive, is a story-driven team challenge built around a simple premise: the club's most valuable AI model has been stolen, and it's up to teams of "recovery agents" to track it down.

Each team starts with a fixed pool of virtual currency, called Compute Credits, and progresses through four themed stations, each testing a different skill — strategic investment, pattern-decoding, spotting real versus AI-generated evidence, and calculated risk-taking. Every station awards credits and a clue, building toward a final deduction: who stole the model, and where it's hidden.

In the closing round, teams combine everything they've uncovered to submit their final answer — and place a bet using their remaining credits on being right. Final standings are based on total credits remaining after this bet, keeping the outcome uncertain until the very end.

No coding or prior AI/ML knowledge is required — the event is designed to be fully accessible to first-year and non-technical participants, blending mystery, teamwork, and strategic decision-making with a light AI/ML theme throughout.

Format at a glance:

Teams of 3–4 participants

Four stations, each worth credits + a clue, followed by a final "Name the Thief" round

Fixed time limits per station

Winner determined by total credits remaining after the final bet, not by speed alone

Key rules:

- **Registration is mandatory; each participant may be part of only one team**
- **Teams must complete all four stations before the final round**
- **Collaboration or answer-sharing between teams is not permitted**
- **Organizers' decisions on scoring and disputes are final**

Rules and Regulations

1. Eligibility & Registration

1 The event is open to all students of the university; priority seating/slots may be given to first-semester students as this is a fest-wide beginner-friendly event.

2 Each team must consist of 3–4 members. Solo participation or teams outside this range will not be permitted.

3 Every team member must register individually (or as a team, per the registration form) before the event begins. On-spot registration, if available, will be subject to slot availability.

4 Each participant may only be part of one team. Being found registered across multiple teams will result in disqualification from all teams involved.

5 Teams must report to the venue 15 minutes before their scheduled slot. Teams arriving after their slot's start time may forfeit their turn or be moved to a later slot, subject to availability.

2. Event Format

1 The event consists of four stations — the Trading Floor, the Training Log, the Lineup, and the Vault — followed by a final round, "Name the Thief."

2 Each team begins with a fixed amount of virtual currency ("Compute Credits") and progresses through each station in sequence.

3 Each station awards credits and/or clues based on team performance at that station.

4 Teams must complete all four stations before proceeding to the final round.

5 A fixed time limit will be enforced at each station. Time extensions will not be granted except at the sole discretion of the organizing team in case of verified technical issues.

6 The order/sequence of stations may be adjusted by organizers to manage crowd flow, without affecting the scoring structure.

3. Scoring & Winning Criteria

1 Final rankings are determined by total Compute Credits remaining after the final bet in the "Name the Thief" round — not by which team finishes first.

2 In the final round, teams must submit their answer (identity of the "thief" and location of the "model") along with a bet — any portion of their remaining credits — on that answer being correct.

3 A correct final answer multiplies the bet amount; an incorrect answer forfeits the bet amount, per the multiplier/payout structure announced at the event.